

Arch Linux & EndeavourOS Post-Install Guide: From Fresh Install to Daily Driver

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A complete post-installation setup guide for Arch Linux and EndeavourOS. Covers pacman tuning, reflector, yay, PipeWire audio, graphics drivers, zram, firewall, and essential daily utilities.

Completing a minimal Arch Linux install or landing on the EndeavourOS desktop is only half the battle. A freshly installed system lacks several essential optimizations: pacman mirror ranking, multilib repositories, audio plumbing, power management, and an AUR helper.

This post-install checklist walks through configuring Arch Linux or EndeavourOS into a reliable, high-performance daily workstation.

1. Optimize Pacman Configuration

Open `/etc/pacman.conf`:

```
sudo nano
/etc/pacman.conf
```

Find the `[options]` section and make the following adjustments:

```
# Enable parallel downloads (set between 5 and
10)
ParallelDownloads = 5

# Enable terminal color output and pacman
animation
Color
ILoveCandy
VerbosePkgLists
```

Scroll down to the repository section and uncomment the `[multilib]` repository to enable 32-bit software support (required for Steam, Wine, and certain 32-bit libraries):

```
[multilib]
Include =
/etc/pacman.d/mirrorlist
```

Save and exit (Ctrl+O, Enter, Ctrl+X), then synchronize repository databases:

```
sudo pacman
-Syu
```

2. Benchmark and Rank Mirrors with Reflector

Slow download speeds on Arch are usually caused by stale or geographically distant mirrors. Use `reflector` to fetch and rank the 15 fastest HTTPS mirrors:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed reflector rsync
sudo reflector --latest 15 --protocol https --sort rate --save
/etc/pacman.d/mirrorlist
```

To automate mirror updates on a weekly timer, enable the `systemd` service:

```
sudo systemctl enable --now
reflector.timer
```

3. Install an AUR Helper (yay)

The Arch User Repository (AUR) contains nearly every package not found in the official repos. Install `yay` using base development tools:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed base-devel git
git clone https://aur.archlinux.org/yay-
bin.git
cd yay-bin
makepkg -si --noconfirm
cd .. && rm -rf yay-bin
```

Verify the installation and test an update:

```
yay
-Syu
```

4. Verify Audio Stack (PipeWire & WirePlumber)

Modern Arch uses **PipeWire** as the low-latency replacement for PulseAudio and JACK. Ensure all compatibility layers and the WirePlumber session manager are installed:

```
sudo pacman -S --
needed \
  pipewire \
  pipewire-audio \
  pipewire-alsa \
  pipewire-pulse \
  pipewire-jack \
  wireplumber \
  pavucontrol
```

Enable the user services:

```
systemctl --user enable --now pipewire pipewire-pulse
wireplumber
```

Check that PulseAudio emulation is active:

```
pactl info | grep "Server
Name"
```

Output should display: Server Name: PulseAudio (on PipeWire ...)

5. Install GPU Drivers

For NVIDIA

Install DKMS drivers so kernel updates don't break display output:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed nvidia-dkms nvidia-utils lib32-nvidia-utils nvidia-  
settings
```

Enable NVIDIA systemd services for power management:

```
sudo systemctl enable nvidia-suspend.service nvidia-hibernate.service nvidia-  
resume.service
```

For AMD

Install the open-source Mesa drivers and Vulkan loader:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed mesa lib32-mesa xf86-video-amdgpu vulkan-radeon lib32-vulkan-  
radeon
```

For Intel

```
sudo pacman -S --needed mesa lib32-mesa intel-media-driver vulkan-intel lib32-vulkan-  
intel
```

6. Configure ZRAM Swap

ZRAM creates a compressed RAM block device used as swap, significantly improving memory efficiency under heavy loads.

Install zram-generator:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed zram-  
generator
```

Create `/etc/systemd/zram-generator.conf`:

```
sudo nano /etc/systemd/zram-  
generator.conf
```

Add the following configuration:

```
[zram0]
zram-size = min(ram / 2,
8192)
compression-algorithm =
zstd
```

Start the service and verify:

```
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl start systemd-zram-
setup@zram0.service
zramctl
```

7. Enable Essential System Services

Enable SSD TRIM, Bluetooth, and network time synchronization:

```
# Periodic SSD TRIM (runs weekly)
sudo systemctl enable --now fstrim.timer

# Network time synchronization
sudo systemctl enable --now systemd-
timesyncd.service

# Bluetooth (if hardware is present)
sudo pacman -S --needed bluez bluez-utils
sudo systemctl enable --now bluetooth.service
```

8. Configure the UFW Firewall

Install and start the Uncomplicated Firewall:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed ufw
sudo ufw default deny
incoming
sudo ufw default allow
outgoing
sudo ufw enable
sudo systemctl enable
ufw.service
```

9. Set Up Automated Pacman Cache Cleaning

Pacman does not delete old package tarballs automatically from `/var/cache/pacman/pkg/`. Use `paccache` from `pacman-contrib` to keep only the 2 most recent versions:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed pacman-contrib  
sudo systemctl enable --now  
paccache.timer
```

10. Install Fonts, Media Codecs, and Core Tools

Prevent missing glyphs, boxes, and broken font rendering across web pages and documents:

```
# Fonts
sudo pacman -S --needed
\
    noto-fonts \
    noto-fonts-cjk \
    noto-fonts-emoji \
    ttf-liberation \
    ttf-jetbrains-mono-
nerd

# Media codecs and
playback
sudo pacman -S --needed
\
    ffmpeg \
    gstreamer \
    gst-plugins-good \
    gst-plugins-bad \
    gst-plugins-ugly \
    gst-libav \
    mpv

# Essential CLI
Utilities
sudo pacman -S --needed
\
    htop \
    btop \
    fastfetch \
    curl \
    wget \
    unzip \
    p7zip \
    bash-completion
```

Reboot your system to apply all kernel modules, services, and display driver changes:

```
sudo
reboot
```